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- **Candidate database:** Potential solution database of approx 2300 words (if can find the solution database online)
- **Handle Reused words:** Words previously used as solutions by Wordle should be less likely to be guessed (if used in the past year, less likely to guess it), (if used twice already definitely don't guess it again)
- **When to use a non candidate guess:** When to sacrifice a guess to get maximum new information by playing a word you know isn't the answer to get 5 fresh letters
  - Ideal non candidate guess has 5 fresh letters
  - However, it's not always possible to find an ideal one so an un ideal one with maximum fresh new letters is also allowed if no ideal exists
  - Potential decision matrix:

**Never use a non-candidate guess if:**
    - 1 guess left — obvious, just swing to win
    - Candidates remaining  $\leq$  guesses remaining — you can just try them sequentially and guarantee a win, no need to sacrifice anything**Strong case for non-candidate guess if:**
    - 2 guesses left, 3+ candidates — this is your exact example and it's the clearest case. One non-candidate guess to differentiate the remaining candidates, then win on the last guess
    - Many guesses left, large candidate pool — early game info gathering**Weak case / judgement call if:**
    - 3 guesses left, 4-6 candidates — depends on how similar the candidates are. If they all share 4 letters and differ only in one position, a non-candidate targeting that position is worth it. If they're all over the place, just start guessing candidates.